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ENGLISH LANGUAGE STANDARD SEVEN

Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) 2016 Answer Key and Worked Solutions

Subject	English Language
Code	02
Level	Standard Seven
Year	2016
Exam Board	NECTA
Exam	Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE)
Type	Answer key and worked solutions
Questions	50 questions

Try each question before checking the solution. Follow the steps, compare your working, and practise the parts you find difficult.

Source paper: English - S7 - 2016.pdf

Section A — Grammar

1. The window ____ by my father.

Step 1: The window receives the action, so use the passive voice.

Step 2: Past passive = was/were + past participle; singular window takes was opened.

Final Answer: E — was opened

2. I ____ my teeth every morning when I wake up.

Step 1: Every morning indicates a routine in the simple present.

Step 2: With I, use the base form brush, without -s.

Final Answer: C — brush

3. I ____ the television when it started raining.

Step 1: Watching was in progress when another past event happened.

Step 2: Use past continuous: I was + watching.

Final Answer: D — was watching

4. The villagers ____ their environment at the moment.

Step 1: At the moment signals an action happening now.

Step 2: Villagers is plural, so use are + cleaning.

Final Answer: B — are cleaning

5. While they were playing, the teacher ____ swimming.

Step 1: Both activities were taking place in the past.

Step 2: The teacher is singular, so was completes the past continuous.

Final Answer: C — was

6. Mr Musa has been teaching at our school ____ ten years now.

Step 1: Ten years is a duration, not a starting date.

Step 2: Use for with a duration; since introduces a starting point.

Final Answer: A — for

7. We ____ to travel to Mtwara soon.

Step 1: Soon indicates a future plan.

Step 2: The structure is are going to + base verb travel.

Final Answer: B — are going

8. I asked Juma if he could ____ me a piece of paper.

Step 1: Juma gives the paper temporarily to the speaker.

Step 2: That direction is lend; could requires the base form, not lent.

Final Answer: A — lend

9. The fisherman has ____ a lot of fish.

Step 1: Has needs a past participle to form the present perfect.

Step 2: The forms are catch, caught, caught.

Final Answer: C — caught

10. A cheetah normally ____ faster than a tiger.

Step 1: Normally describes a usual characteristic.

Step 2: Singular a cheetah takes the simple-present form runs.

Final Answer: A — runs

11. We watched TV for ____ hour.

Step 1: Hour begins with a vowel sound because h is silent.

Step 2: Use an before a vowel sound: an hour.

Final Answer: B — an

12. I have to wake up early ____ be in school on time.

Step 1: The blank introduces the purpose of waking early.

Step 2: So as to is followed by the base verb be.

Final Answer: E — so as to

13. Many children like ivory sweets, ____?

Step 1: The statement is positive in the simple present.

Step 2: Use a negative do-tag with plural they, and end the question tag with a question mark.

Final Answer: D — don't they?

14. I saw a cat in the bush. ____ cat was black in colour.

Step 1: The cat has already been introduced.

Step 2: Use the for the particular cat the reader now knows.

Final Answer: B — The

15. Chausiku does all the homework ____ she wants to be first in class.

Step 1: The second clause gives the reason for doing homework.

Step 2: Because joins an action to its reason.

Final Answer: E — because

16. The man ____ shirt was torn was in the academic office.

Step 1: The shirt belongs to the man.

Step 2: Whose expresses possession in a relative clause.

Final Answer: C — whose

17. In our class, Jalia is ____ than Jamila.

Step 1: Than signals a comparison between two people.

Step 2: Use the comparative shorter, rather than the superlative shortest.

Final Answer: B — shorter

18. ____ you study hard, you are going to fail.

Step 1: The sentence warns of failure if the condition is not met.

Step 2: Unless means if not: if you do not study hard, you will fail.

Final Answer: E — Unless

19. Juma had ____ of time to prepare for his examination.

Step 1: The next word is of.

Step 2: Plenty of is the correct expression for a large amount of time.

Final Answer: A — plenty

20. Our class monitor put the English books ____ the table.

Step 1: Books rest on the upper surface of a table.

Step 2: Use on for contact with a surface.

Final Answer: B — on

21. ____ is hunger because of the poor rainfall.

Step 1: The sentence announces the existence of a situation.

Step 2: There is is used to introduce a singular or uncountable noun.

Final Answer: C — There

22. How ____ money do you need to buy a bus?

Step 1: Money is uncountable in this use.

Step 2: Ask how much money, rather than how many money.

Final Answer: B — much

23. You can go ____ to school or to the farm.

Step 1: The sentence offers two alternatives joined by or.

Step 2: The paired construction is either ... or.

Final Answer: D — either

24. Report Ally's words: "I'm trying to get home in time."

Step 1: Change I to he because Ally is now being reported.

Step 2: After past said, the expected backshift changes am trying to was trying.

Final Answer: E — Ally said that he was trying to get home in time.

25. This is the ____ news I have ever heard.

Step 1: Ever heard compares this news with all previous news.

Step 2: Use the superlative best after the.

Final Answer: B — best

26. Jane is a friend ____ I share the front desk.

Step 1: We share a desk with someone.

Step 2: Keep with before the object relative pronoun whom.

Final Answer: C — with whom

27. Has Maganga ever ____ off his bicycle?

Step 1: Has needs a past participle.

Step 2: Fall has the forms fall, fell, fallen.

Final Answer: C — fallen

28. Jane had to go ____ Anne because she was sick.

Step 1: The sentence describes accompanying Anne.

Step 2: Go with someone means accompany that person.

Final Answer: B — with

29. The headmaster switched ____ the television to watch the football match.

Step 1: The television must be operating to show the match.

Step 2: Switch on means start a device; switch off means stop it.

Final Answer: A — on

30. Is there ____ room for him to sleep in?

Step 1: This is a neutral question about the availability of space.

Step 2: Any is the expected determiner in such a question.

Final Answer: B — any

Study Tip: Some or more can be grammatical in a suitably different context. Any is the intended neutral availability question in this exercise.

Section Summary: Identify the time clue, subject and sentence structure before checking the options. For question tags, change a positive statement to a negative tag.

Section B — Vocabulary

31. What is the political leader of a country without a king or queen called in the choices?

Step 1: A monarch is a king or queen; a mayor leads a town or city.

Step 2: President is the national leadership title intended among these options.

Final Answer: A — The president.

32. The sister of your mother is your ____.

Step 1: Start from the family relationship: your mother's sibling.

Step 2: A female sibling of either parent is an aunt.

Final Answer: B — aunt

33. A citizen of Sudan is a ____.

Step 1: The question asks for the nationality word.

Step 2: Sudanese is used for a person from Sudan.

Final Answer: E — Sudanese

34. A lady who is not married is called a ____ in the listed choices.

Step 1: Bachelor refers to an unmarried man; fiancée refers to an engaged woman.

Step 2: Spinster is the older vocabulary term the examination expects.

Final Answer: D — spinster

Study Tip: For ordinary present-day writing, unmarried woman is usually a more natural description.

35. Ali was first, John third, and I was ____.

Step 1: The three positions are first, second and third.

Step 2: The remaining position is the ordinal second, not the number two.

Final Answer: C — second

36. What is the opposite of forget?

Step 1: Forget means fail to recall.

Step 2: Remember means keep or bring something to mind; retain the base verb form.

Final Answer: A — remember

Section Summary: Use the relationship or word class requested. Nationalities, family terms and ordinal numbers have distinct forms.

Section C — Composition

37. Arrange: Take honey bees as an example.

Step 1: First introduce insects and then classify them as helpful or harmful.

Step 2: Only after that general statement should a particular example be introduced.

Final Answer: C — third sentence.

38. Arrange: They produce wax which can be used in many ways.

Step 1: They must refer to a group already named.

Step 2: Honey bees are introduced in the third sentence, so this explanation follows it.

Final Answer: D — fourth sentence.

39. Arrange: There are many kinds of insects around us.

Step 1: A composition starts by introducing its general topic.

Step 2: This sentence names insects before later sentences refer to them.

Final Answer: A — first sentence.

40. Arrange: Some of the insects are beneficial while others are harmful.

Step 1: The insects refers back to insects introduced in sentence 39.

Step 2: It classifies them before sentence 37 gives a beneficial example.

Final Answer: B — second sentence.

Study Tip: Complete order: 39 → 40 → 37 → 38. Letters for questions 37-40: C, D, A, B.

Section Summary: Start with the general subject, develop a category, introduce an example, then explain it. Check every pronoun has an earlier noun.

Section D — Comprehension

41. Which animal was cleverer than the Hare?

Step 1: The Hare ran fastest but did not notice a passenger on his tail.

Step 2: The Chameleon used that advantage to reach the throne first.

Final Answer: C — The Chameleon.

42. Which word in the story refers to runners in a race?

Step 1: Use the word actually present in the first sentence.

Step 2: Contestants are those taking part in a competition.

Final Answer: C — Contestants.

43. Where did the Frog and the Snake go to watch the race?

Step 1: The Frog proposed a place from which they could see clearly.

Step 2: He specifically said to climb to the top of the hill.

Final Answer: A — To the top of the hill.

44. The ____ ran fastest but ____ won the race.

Step 1: Separate running speed from the race result.

Step 2: The Hare ran fastest; the Chameleon reached the seat first by riding on him.

Final Answer: B — Hare; the Chameleon.

45. Which animal became King of the forest?

Step 1: The Hare claimed the title, but the Chameleon said he was already on the seat.

Step 2: The celebrating friends recognised the Chameleon as the new king.

Final Answer: E — Chameleon.

46. Which animals were the happiest?

Step 1: Look for the pair described as happy at the result.

Step 2: They celebrated the success of their friend, the Chameleon.

Final Answer: A — The Frog and the Snake.

47. What did the winner of the race do?

Step 1: The winner rode on the Hare without the Hare noticing.

Step 2: That was a trick, not evidence that he ran faster or bribed anyone.

Final Answer: C — He played a trick to win the race.

48. Who were the Frog's friends?

Step 1: The Frog watched together with the Snake.

Step 2: He also called the Chameleon their friend.

Final Answer: D — Chameleon and Snake.

49. What does throne mean in the story?

Step 1: The Hare sat down on the throne.

Step 2: The word names a royal seat, rather than the whole palace or racing ground.

Final Answer: D — The chair on which the king sits.

50. Which is the best title among the choices?

Step 1: A suitable title covers the central event of the entire story.

Step 2: The contest between the animals, with its surprising result, is the main event.

Final Answer: E — The animals' race.

Section Summary: Distinguish what characters claim from the final outcome. Use details from the passage rather than assumptions about animal speed.